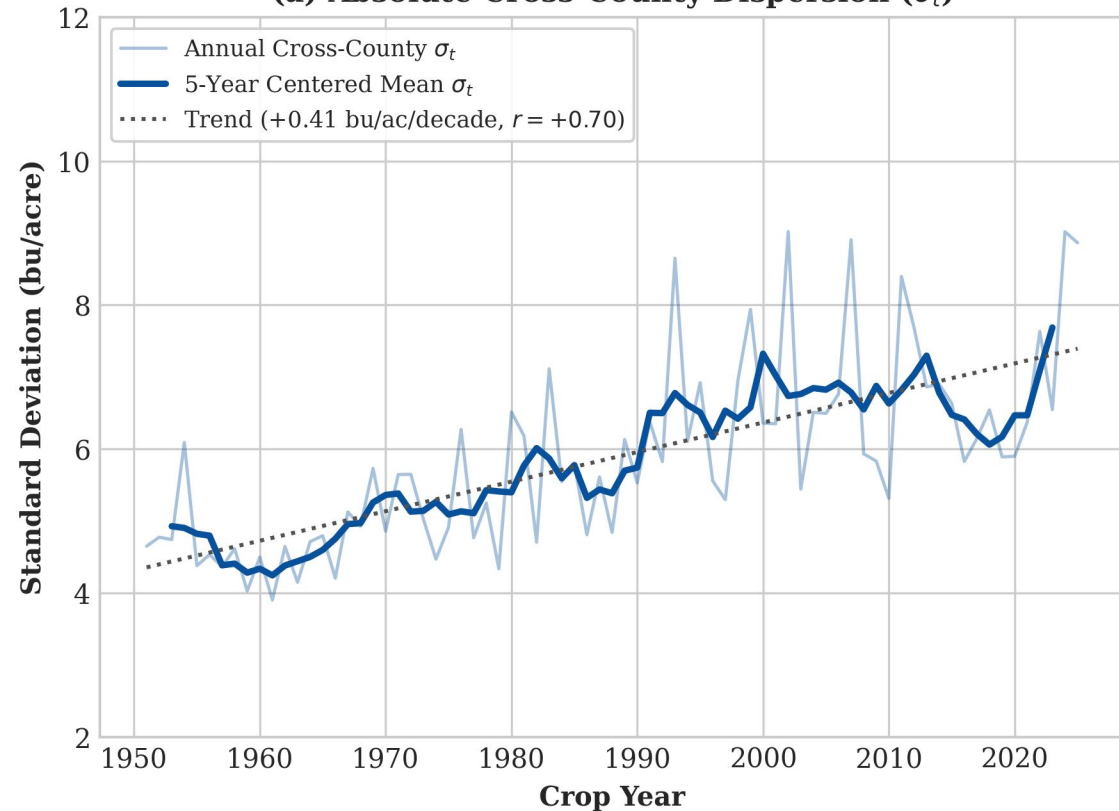


Dispersion Dynamics: Rising Absolute Variance vs. Declining Relative Volatility (1951--2025)

(a) Absolute Cross-County Dispersion (σ_t)



(b) Relative Volatility ($CV_t = 100 \times \sigma_t/\mu_t$)

